



Package management tips

To check whether a package is present in the repositories or to check the version and size of the software, open the terminal and enter in root mode. After that, perform the following commands, depending on your distro:

- Debian/Ubuntu: `aptitude search <package_name>`
- Mandriva: `urpmq <package_name>`
- Fedora: `yum list <package_name>`
- openSUSE: `zypper search <package_name>`
- Sabayon: `equo match <package_name>`
- Arch Linux: `pacman -Ss <package_name>`

To know the number and name of packages installed, use the following commands based on your distro:

- Debian/Ubuntu: `dpkg -f`
- Mandriva/Fedora/openSUSE: `rpm -qa`
- Sabayon: `equo list`
- Arch Linux: `pacman -Q`

To list the repositories activated/installed, use the following commands:

- Debian/Ubuntu: `cat /etc/apt/sources.list`
- Mandriva: `urpmq --list-media`
- Fedora: `yum repolist`
- openSUSE: `zypper repos`
- Sabayon: `equo repoinfo`
- Arch Linux: `cat /etc/pacman.conf`

Please note that you need to use the `sudo` or `su` command to gain root privileges.

—Shashwat Pant, shashwat.pant@gmail.com

Simple VIM tricks

While in `vi` editor, you can configure some items on-the-fly such as line numbers.

- `:set number`—causes line numbers to be displayed
- `:set nonumber`—to turn off the line numbers
- `:set ignorecase`—causes searches to be case insensitive
- `:help`—to list other such commands

—Vivek, wizardvivek@gmail.com

To spell-check in a `vi` editor

To do a spell-check without leaving a `vi` session, try the following key sequence inside `vi`:

```
:w !spell -b
```

This will give you the list of words that are misspelled.

—Shabeer V V, shabeer.vv@hotmail.com

Delete files older than 'x' days

The `find` utility allows you to pass in a bunch of interesting arguments, including one to execute another command on each file. We'll use this in order to figure out what files are older than a certain number of days, and then use the `rm` command to delete them. The command syntax is as follows:

```
find /path/to/files* -mtime +5 -exec rm {} \;
```

You can always list the files and check before deleting anything, by running the following command:

```
find /path/to/files* -mtime +5 -exec ls {} \;
```

Note that there are spaces between `rm`, `{}`, and `;`.

In the above command, the first argument is the path to the files. `-mtime` is used to specify how many days old the file is. If you enter `+5`, it will find files older than five days. `-exec` allows you to pass in a command such as `rm`. The `{}` at the end is required to end the command.

—Remin Raphael, remin13@gmail.com